

New York Cuisine

The Conscious Foodie: 5 Healthy Restaurant Picks

POV: You've finished your workout, and you're ready to replenish your strength with a nutrient packed meal. After all, great abs are made in the kitchen—not the gym! Here's a list of our top 5 local spots, plus wholesome menu picks this month:

Divya's Kitchen

Nestled in the East Village, Divya's attracts the Zen New York crowd. With its cream walls, dim lights, and wood furnishes, you'll feel as though you've just stepped inside your local yoga studio. Aesthetics aside, Divya's boasts a certain homemade, cozy feel in its menu selection. We'd recommend the vegetable curry cooked in a cashew sauce—an amazing choice for spicy food lovers. The blend of vibrant-colored vegetables combined with notes of cinnamon make for an aromatic dining experience, not to mention packing a solid dose of fiber and Vitamin C in every bite!

By Chloe

By Chloe is a well-known staple for native New Yorkers. With locations all over the island, it's almost the fast food of vegan options. But have you ever made it early enough to try out their breakfast menu? Celebrate your hard-earned sweat by indulging in a sweet, but hearty breakfast. By Chloe's Morning Oats include quinoa, flaxseed, and fresh berries. We also topped ours with raw almond butter, pure maple, and cacao. Talk about a good morning!

Citizens

We know you love your avocado toast, but Citizens—a quick joint with locations in both Chelsea and Gramercy—takes the classic to a new level. Grab a seat and enjoy the greenery and nature-inspired décor, quite on par with the colors on your plate. Inspired by Australian “brekkie” spots, Citizen's avocado toast comes garnished with beet hummus, pumpkin seeds, pickled onions, and watermelon radishes. Sprinkle on some feta cheese, citrus, and cilantro, and the result is a flavor-packed take on the original hit breakfast. Pop a poached egg on there too for good measure —why not?

Peacefood Cafe

Next up on the list is a vegan lover's dream. Craving a classic grilled cheese sandwich? One of our favorite picks at Peacefood is the roasted Japanese Pumpkin sandwich. The roasted pumpkin paired with creamy cashew and sautéed onions makes for an altogether flawless cheese substitute. Avoid the dairy bloat while still getting your fix! With 5 locations spanning uptown to downtown, this staple in vegan cuisine can't be missed.

Candle Café

Finishing off our list with grand number five - we have Candle Café on the Upper West Side. When it comes to salads, Candle Café doesn't skip out on the goods. One of our favorites is the signature Grilled Kale Salad. Packed with kabocha squash, beluga lentils, avocado, and sunflower seeds, this salad has the perfect amount of texture and crunch in every bite. Top it off with a chive vinaigrette, and your taste buds will surely be thanking you!